

Transportation Solutions Operating Benchmark

SUBVERTICAL LENS

Four models require separate estimates: railcar leasing, locomotive leasing, airport GSE leasing and outsourced yard logistics. Asset lessors earn higher margins with heavier reinvestment; yard logistics is labor-led, lower-margin and much lighter-capital.

METRIC	ESTIMATE		ASSERTION	CONFIDENCE
Revenue growth	Railcar 4%	Loco 6%	Railcar growth is held to 4% because mature fleets depend mainly on rate, utilization and measured additions; locomotives receive 6% for modernization demand. GSE and yard services receive 8% and 7% for outsourcing, electrification and new-site wins.	MEDIUM
	GSE 8%	Yard 7%		
EBITDA margin	Railcar 58%	Loco 62%	Railcar and locomotive estimates remain high because lease revenue sits on long-lived assets; the 62% locomotive estimate is normalized below Akiem's roughly 68% result. GSE carries workshop costs, while yard services are labor-led.	MEDIUM
	GSE 30%	Yard 14%		
Maintenance capex / revenue	Railcar 18%	Loco 18%	Railcar and locomotive estimates reflect overhaul, replacement, compliance and ERTMS work; GSE's 14% reflects refurbishment, batteries and workshop support. Yard services require only tractors and technology at 4%.	MEDIUM
	GSE 14%	Yard 4%		
Customer tenor INITIAL / EFFECTIVE	Railcar 4 / 9 yrs	Loco 7 / 12 yrs	Initial terms lengthen with asset value, approval burden and mobilization complexity, making locomotives longest and yard contracts shortest. Effective tenure is longer because fleets, airport packages and embedded yard operations are commonly renewed or refreshed.	MEDIUM
	GSE 5 / 9 yrs	Yard 3 / 7 yrs		
Utilization exposure	Railcar Moderate	Loco Moderate	Rail exposure is Moderate because leased deployment matters but assets can be redeployed across long economic lives. GSE adds station activity and spare-fleet risk, while yard services are High because contribution depends on productive labor hours.	MEDIUM
	GSE Moderate-High	Yard High		
New-unit / customer payback	Railcar 9 yrs	Loco 10 yrs	Rail assets receive nine-to-ten-year paybacks because high upfront cost must be recovered over multiple placements and residual value matters. GSE is cheaper but service-heavy at 5.5 years, while yard launch spend can recover in about 1.5 years.	MEDIUM
	GSE 5.5 yrs	Yard 1.5 yrs		
B2B vs B2C	All models Predominantly B2B		All four models are predominantly B2B because contractual buyers are rail operators, public authorities, airports, ground handlers, industrial firms and logistics providers. The benchmarked operations have no meaningful direct consumer revenue.	HIGH

SUBSECTOR CATEGORIES				
Railcar leasing VTG		Locomotive leasing Akiem	Airport GSE leasing Air Rail / TCR	Yard logistics Lazer Logistics
VTG RAILCAR LEASING		Akiem LOCOMOTIVE LEASING	Lazer Logistics YARD LOGISTICS	
Evidence. 2024: EUR405m operating cash flow and EUR536m fixed-asset investment, mainly new wagons and maintenance; tank utilization stayed high while intermodal softened. Business. Leases and manages European freight wagons for industrial shippers and rail operators. Economics. Unit: earning wagon; revenue: recurring lease plus services. Customers avoid capital and secure compliant, cargo-specific capacity. VTG maintains and redeploys fleets; integration retains customers, while lane loss and intermodal weakness create churn.		Evidence. 2021: 600+ locomotives, 46 passenger trains, about EUR220m revenue and EUR150m EBITDA. Business. Leases and maintains locomotives and some passenger rolling stock across Europe. Economics. Unit: locomotive under lease/full service. Operators outsource scarce, compliant traction. Akiem runs workshops, overhauls and upgrades; approvals and uptime support retention, while concession loss or technical mismatch cause churn.	Evidence. EQT reports 550+ sites, 5,000 employees, 6,000 fleet assets and 9m annual service hours. Business. Runs warehouse and industrial yards using drivers, equipment, processes and technology. Economics. Unit: site contract/service hour. Recurring site and labor revenue solves trailer-flow bottlenecks. Lazer staffs and supervises yards; integration supports retention, while rebids, closures and volume loss cause churn.	
Air Rail AIRPORT GSE LEASING		TCR AIRPORT GSE LEASING		
Evidence. IFM owns 75%. March 2026: 4,700+ units, about 60 airports, eight countries and 68% of motorized units electric. Business. AIR RAIL, S.L. leases, maintains and refurbishes airport GSE; it also has rail activities. Economics. Unit: deployed GSE/station package. Rental, maintenance, parts and resale solve airline/handler capex and uptime needs. Airport service embeds relationships; rebids and transfer friction cause churn. Fleets, batteries and charging drive capital needs.		Evidence. 44,000+ assets, 100+ workshops, 1,800+ employees, 24 countries and 200+ airports. Business. Rents, maintains, refurbishes and electrifies GSE for airlines, handlers and airports. Economics. Unit: GSE/airport fleet package. Full-service rent and lifecycle services solve turnaround uptime and capital needs. Workshops, technicians and spares embed TCR; handler rebids drive churn.		